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<https://x.com/RiikonenMarko/status/1758131616315322378>

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Snowpack displays require certain dedication as there is some level of physical exertion involved and as it probably doesn't have that oomph for most people (some may even consider it sacrilegious). Actually, I don't think anybody else will do it.

But it may be possible at least to remove the first snag – provided one is motivated enough to construct a box. Have a black box with one side transparent for the light source far outside the box, on the opposite side a hole for the camera lens. Put a fan inside. And then just place some snow inside and let crystals fly.

On paper, this looks like a perfect solution. Every photo would be usable for the stack. When you snow-throw yourself, the process is very sloppy. Most frames go to waste because the angular coverage of the snow curtain is incomplete, or the curtain is too thin or thick (the latter leading to overexposure).

With the box, you could study much more precisely different layers of the snowpack. Over the winter, unleashing these hidden halo potentials would gain an intimate knowledge on the workings of the prismatic crystals in the snowpack. Even if the displays will turn out to be basic odd radii one after another, it is an exploration worth having done. But nature is unlikely that boring. So expect 28 and 13° halos thrown to boot sometimes. And that is when, of course, the microscope must enter the game.

The biggest question mark would seem to be how large that box needs to be. Generally, the closer the lamp and camera are, the smaller is the space in which the display forms. We have done displays at close distances in which the width of the effective beam around the camera lens must have been (well) under one meter. So you don't need a shipping container. It should be possible to do some experiments to find answers.
